A Narrative Campaign Supplement

War in Middle-earth

Campaign Rules & Logistics

✦ ✦ ✦

Eriador · Rohan · Gondor · The North

DISCLAIMER

1. I am not an expert at MESBG by any means and play completely casually. As a result, the balancing of various abilities in this ruleset may not be the best.

   It is highly encouraged that anyone who decides to give this a whirl discusses with their fellow player any rules they may deem to be unfair. Additionally, I am always open to feedback!

2. The Faction Lists are very much a work in progress and, if preferred, can be completely altered or ignored. Discuss this with whoever you're playing with!

3. There are multiple armies that require you to take a certain leader, which means you can only ever have one of that army in your game at any given time. There are three options here:

   - Waive that army's requirement to have a specified leader.
   - Waive that specific army's leader limit in the campaign.
   - Waive the rule regarding a list not being able to have the same leader multiple times.

4. The reason I added the restrictions on named Heroes leading multiple of the same list is because I really wanted to create something that pushed players to get creative with their lists. Otherwise I feel the campaign would be the same copy-and-paste army fighting over and over.

5. I didn't put too much thought into which lists would and wouldn't make sense together, and didn't want to limit army list selection more than it already is. So these rules don't really care about using armies from different time periods together at once. But as with any of these rules, you are free to make your own judgements!

The Campaigns

Across the wide lands of the West the armies of Light and Shadow gather. Choose your theatre of war, muster your forces and contest every region of the map.

War in Eriador

Forces of Good

Arnor · Arathorn's Stand · Rivendell · Fornost · Lindon · The Shire

Sister Kingdom: may field one Minas Tirith army that does not count as a Mercenary.

Forces of Evil

Host of the Witch-king · Carn Dûm · Buhdur's · Shadows of Angmar · Wolf Pack of Angmar · Moria

Angmar's Origin: may field one Mordor army that does not count as a Mercenary.

War in Rohan

Forces of Good

All Rohan lists (excluding Grief of Éomer) · Lothlórien

Riches of the Glittering Caves: may field one Army of Erebor army that does not count as a Mercenary.

Forces of Evil

All Isengard lists · Dunland lists

Saruman's Influence: may field one Moria army that does not count as a Mercenary.

War in Gondor

Forces of Good

All Gondor lists · Fiefdoms

The Beacons are Lit: may field one Kingdom of Rohan army that does not count as a Mercenary.

Forces of Evil

All Mordor lists · Harad · Serpent Horde · Far Harad · Umbar

Mercenaries from the North: may field one The Easterlings army that does not count as a Mercenary.

War in the North

Forces of Good

All Erebor lists · All Dale lists

Kin of Khazad-dûm: may field one Khazad-dûm army that does not count as a Mercenary.

Forces of Evil

All Easterling lists · Dol Guldur lists · Gundabad lists

Goblin-town's Hire: may field one Goblin-town army that does not count as a Mercenary.

✦ Work in progress — faction lists are agreed case by case between players ✦

Starting Supplies

Every faction taking part in the campaign begins the war with **400 Resource Points**, held in its capital, with which to raise its first armies, agents and buildings. All other territories begin with no resources.

Fortified Capitals

Each faction's capital begins the campaign with Fortifications already built.

Winning the Campaign

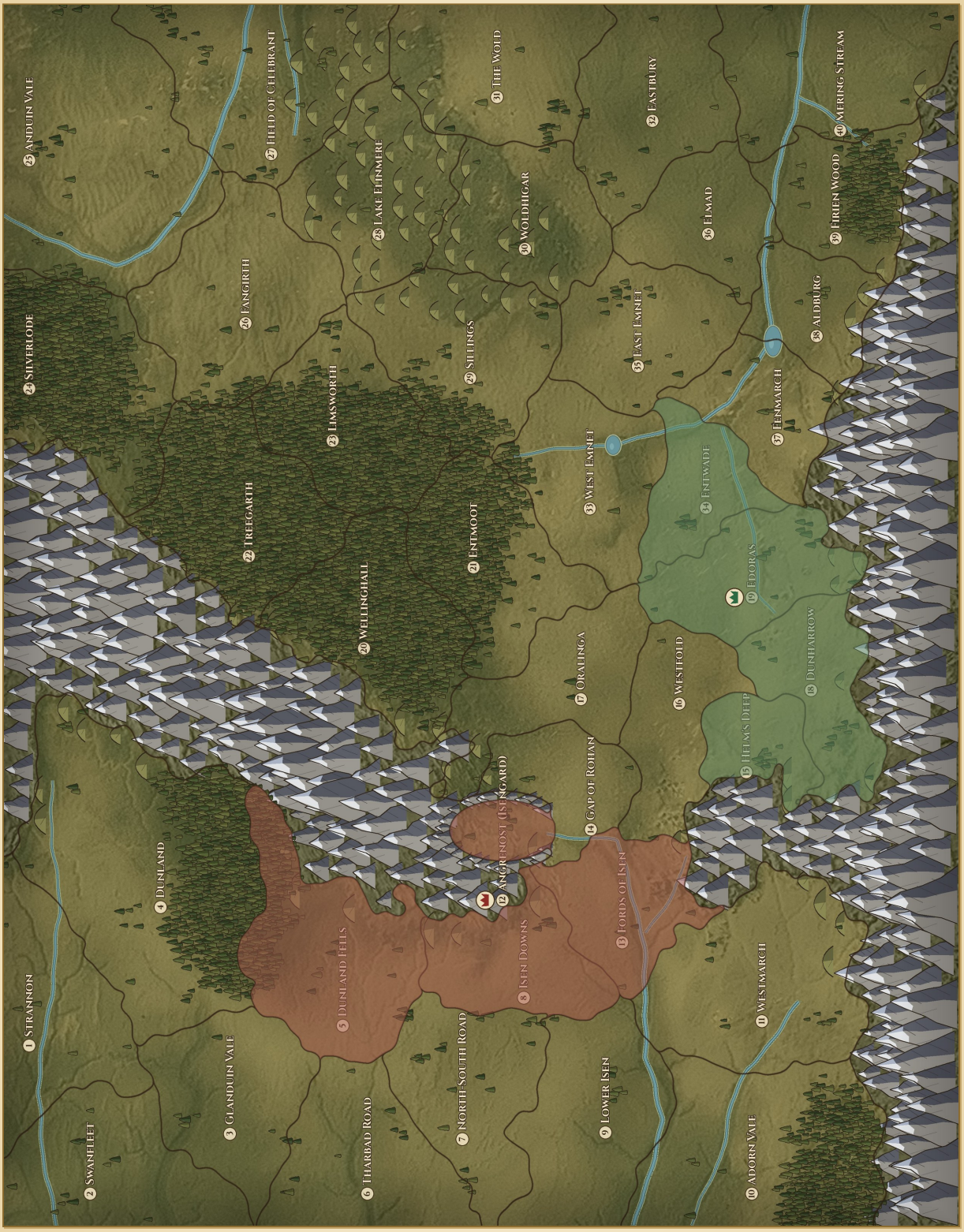
Victory

By default, the campaign is won as soon as one side has lost all of its territory.

The Map of Eriador


6 • Capital
26 • Capital
Angmar
The Lone Lands
The Shire
Eregion
Minhiriath
Old Cardolan
Old Arthedain
Forodwaith
Ice Bay of Forochel
Numeriador
Lune Valley
The Waste
The Iron Hills
The Misty Mountains
Rhudaur
The Trollshaws
The Angle
Hills of Evendim
Lake Nenuial
Lake Evendim
Weathertop
Bree-hill
Bree
Old Forest
Midgewater Marshes
Barrow-downs
Brandywine River
Tharbad
Dol Cardolan
Moria
Lothlórien
Rivendell
Ettenmoors
Trollshaws
Angle
Eregion
Minhiriath
Cardolan
Arthedain
Lone Lands
Shire
Lune Valley
Numeriador
Forodwaith
Ice Bay of Forochel
Misty Mountains
Rhudaur
Angmar
Waste
Iron Hills

The Map of Rohan



Good at the start · Evil at the start · Neutral · ♛ capital (fortified)

The Map of Gondor



Good at the start · Evil at the start · Neutral · ♛ capital (fortified) · West above, east below

The Map of the North



Good at the start | Evil at the start | Neutral | ♛ capital (fortified) | North to the left

The Campaign Turn

The campaign is played in phases, just like a typical battle. Each campaign turn is divided into the following stages, resolved in order.

1 Priority Stage

Both players roll against each other for Priority. The winner decides who acts first in each of the following stages.

2 Logistics Stage

During the Logistics Stage a player may:

- **Move Units** – All units on the map may move through a number of regions depending on their type.
- **Use Unit Abilities** – There are more than just armies on the map. Agent Units such as Scouts may use their abilities in this stage.
- **Transfer Supplies** – Supply Wagons or adjacent armies may transfer supplies to one another.

3 Building Stage

During the Building Stage a player may:

- **Construction** – Begin or continue building projects across your territories.
- **Replenish** – Armies that have been diminished regenerate here.
- **Create Armies** – Spend resources to raise new armies.

4 Battle Stage

All battles that are due to take place this turn are fought in this stage.

5 Retreat Stage

Defeated armies that were not completely destroyed must retreat at least 2 territories through friendly or neutral land (see Battles).

6 End Stage

The turn ends and a new campaign turn begins.

Building Armies

Armies may be built in one of four point ranges: **400, 600, 800 or 1,000 points**. Certain scenarios may allow greater armies to be formed. Raising an army costs both resources and time.

Army Size	Cost	Build Time
400 points	150 RP	2 turns
600 points	300 RP	3 turns
800 points	450 RP	4 turns
1,000 points	600 RP	5 turns

Army Leaders

An Army Leader can only ever lead one army at a time, unless that Leader is an unnamed standard Hero.

Point Cap

There is no limit on the number of armies a side may field. Instead each side has a **Point Cap** of **2,000 points**, which rises by **600 points** for every City that side owns. You may build any number of armies, so long as their total points do not exceed your cap. Armies still being raised count, and an army being upgraded counts at its new size.

EXAMPLE

Good owns one City, so its cap is 2,600 points. It fields an 800 and a 1,000 point army (1,800 points), so it may still raise up to 800 more points: one 800 point army, or two 400 point armies.

EXAMPLE

Aragorn leads a 600 point army, so he cannot lead another army. If he were not leading an army he could still be part of one. A Captain of Gondor, however, could be the Leader of any number of armies.

Editing & Upgrading

Once an army is built, it may be edited during the Replenish step for an extra **25 Resources**.

An army's point range can be upgraded, but this is more expensive overall than building it from scratch. Each upgrade costs **200 Resources and 1 turn**.

Mercenary Armies

Mercenary Armies are armies drawn from outside your faction's lists. You can hire Mercenaries from any list that shares your alignment.

Mercenary Limits

You may only ever have one Mercenary army from a given faction at a time, and no more than two Mercenary army lists in total.

EXAMPLE

You cannot have both Minas Tirith and Garrison of Ithilien as Mercenary armies, but you could have Minas Tirith and Khazad-dûm.

Campaign Alliances

Each campaign names one allied list for each side (see The Campaigns). A side may field one army from its allied list at a time without it counting as a Mercenary: it pays no Mercenary surcharge, has normal Replenish costs and does not count towards the two-Mercenary limit. Further armies from that list are Mercenaries as normal.

Mercenaries grow more expensive for every active Mercenary army you have, and carry higher Replenish costs:

Active Mercenaries	Hire Cost	Replenish
1 army	50 RP	25 RP
2 armies	75 RP	50 RP

Disbanding Armies

Armies can be disbanded to recover some of the resources spent on them:

Army State	Resources Returned
Intact	50%
Broken	25%
Quartered	None

Movement & Replenishing

Movement

Different armies have different move speeds, and the unique units of the campaign each have movement speeds of their own.

Unit	Movement
400 point army	2 regions
600+ point army	1 region
Cavalry-only army (400)	3 regions
Cavalry-only army (600+)	2 regions
Agent Units	2 regions
Supply Wagons	3 regions (entering or leaving Neutral land costs 2)

The **Wolf Pack of Angmar** always counts as a Cavalry-only army, even though it lacks the Cavalry keyword.

Meeting the Enemy

An army that moves into a territory holding an enemy army must stop there; it is engaged and the two fight in the Battle stage.

Replenishing

Armies that have lost 25%, 50% or 75% of their strength must spend resources to replenish.

Army	25% Lost	50% Lost	75% Lost
400 pts	50	75	100
600 pts	125	150	175
800 pts	200	225	250
1,000 pts	275	300	325

Replenishing can be made cheaper by doing so in territories that contain certain buildings, such as a Hospital.

Casualties

Armies that have lost 25/50/75% of their strength must drop units from their army as if the army's points maximum were 25/50/75% lower.

Leaderless Victory

If you win a battle but all of your warband leaders were killed, your casualties are increased by **25%**. Your army cannot drop below 25% of its strength in this way.

Vulnerable While Replenishing

An army is particularly vulnerable while it replenishes. Armies attacked in the same turn in which they replenished suffer a −1 penalty to all Priority rolls, and do not fully recover their lost units until the end of the turn.

Battles

When armies meet, the battle is fought in the Battle stage. The losing army is **Broken**, **Quartered** or **Destroyed**, and that result decides what it loses afterwards.

On the Battlefield

Quartered

When an army is reduced to 25% and is Quartered, the game does not end immediately. Instead it ends at the end of that turn, giving the enemy the chance to destroy the army properly.

Leaderless

At the end of a battle, if your army was Quartered and you have no Warband Leaders remaining, your army is Destroyed.

Calling the Retreat

The retreat **must be called the moment you are Broken**; if you play on past that point, you may no longer call it in that battle. From then on, any of your models that reach a board edge are retreated and do not count as Casualties. While on the retreat your models cannot make shooting attacks or Strikes to wound. Casualties suffered from failed Courage tests for being Broken still count as Casualties. Calling the retreat means you automatically lose the battle. An army that called the retreat counts as **Broken**, never Quartered, even if it fell below 25% — unless it was Destroyed. Once an army has called the retreat, it cannot call it again for the **next 2 campaign turns**.

Battles With Several Armies

When a battle occurs in a territory holding **more than 2 armies**:

Even Numbers

If both players have the same number of armies there, both start the battle with all their armies deployed.

Reinforcements

If one player has more armies than the other, they deploy armies to match their opponent's number, and the armies left over must wait to reinforce. Starting on **turn 4** of the battle, that player rolls a D6 for each warband of the reinforcing army: on a **4+** it arrives at that player's deployment board edge. Each time a warband fails to arrive, the roll it needs is lowered by 1, to a minimum of **2+**.

More Than One Extra Army

If you have more than one army over your opponent, you choose the order your reinforcing armies arrive in. Each further reinforcing army starts arriving **4 turns later** than the one before it: turn 8, turn 12 and so on.

Laying Siege

A Siege is never fought in the turn it begins. When an army ends up in an enemy territory with Fortifications, it lays siege; the Siege battle is fought in the Battle stage of the **following turn** (or any later turn), so long as the attackers are still there.

- **Relief:** if an army marches on the besiegers in the turn the siege begins, they fight an ordinary battle that turn. If the besiegers lose, the siege is lifted and they retreat as normal.
- **Lifting the siege:** the besiegers may lift the siege and leave, but that turn they move at most **1 territory**, whatever their usual movement or special rules.

Sieges With Several Armies

In a Siege, at most **2 armies per side** may take part. An attacker who outnumbers the defender reinforces as normal, rolling to arrive from the start of turns 4, 8 and so on. If the **defender** has a reinforcing army, they must choose one:

- deploy **half** of the reinforcing army inside the fort, with the other half reinforcing from **turn 6**, rolling for each warband as above; or
- have the reinforcing army arrive as normal from **turn 4**, entering from either the left or the right board edge.

Siege Supplies

In a Siege, both sides receive extra points to spend only on siege equipment for that battle.

- **Attacker:** each attacking army gives **20 points** for every point interval of its size: a 400 pt army gives 20 points, 600 gives 40, 800 gives 60 and 1,000 gives 80. Several attacking armies each add their own.
- **Defender:** the garrison gives **30 points** for every point interval of its size: the standard 400 pt garrison gives 30 points, a 600 pt garrison 60, and so on. Defending armies add nothing.

EXAMPLE

Evil has three armies in Fornost and Good has one. Evil deploys one army; its second army rolls to arrive from turn 4 and its third from turn 8, in the order Evil chooses. A warband that rolls a 2 on turn 4 needs a 3+ on turn 5.

After the Battle

Retreating

In the Retreat stage, a defeated army that survived must retreat **at least 2 territories**. An army with a movement speed faster than 2 may retreat any distance up to its full movement. The retreat must pass through and end in friendly or neutral territory, and cannot pass through or end in a territory holding an enemy army. If there is nowhere 2 territories away it can reach, it retreats 1 territory instead.

Pressing the Advantage

When an army wins a battle against an enemy army in a territory being conquered:

- If the winner was conquering an **enemy** territory, that territory takes **1 less turn** to conquer.
- If the loser was conquering the winner's territory, the loser drops **twice as many Resources** as it normally would.
- If either army was conquering a **Neutral** territory, the winner conquers it **immediately**.

Spoils of Victory

An army that wins a battle in an **enemy** territory it is not conquering immediately pillages it of **all** its Resources. The territory produces no Resources for 1 turn.

Agent Units

Not every war is won on the battlefield. Agents move across the map to spy, sabotage, heal and kill.

Scout — 40 Resources

When a Scout enters the same territory as an enemy army, it automatically learns who that army's Leader is. The Scout then rolls a D6 – on a **3+**, you learn what units the army contains. An army still being raised can't be scouted, and its size stays secret until it is ready.

Move	Requires
2 regions	Tavern

Assassin — 100 Resources

The Assassin can kill enemy Agent Units and pre-emptively wound enemy Hero models.

Targeting an Agent: Roll a D6. On a 6 the enemy Agent is killed; on a 1 your Assassin dies instead.

Targeting a Hero: The Hero suffers a Wound until the start of the next Movement stage on a 6, then a 4+. If the Hero is a Leader, this requires a 6, then a 5+.

The Assassin dies on a natural 1, so long as that 1 is the first dice rolled.

Move	Requires
2 regions	Slums

Surgeon — 80 Resources

Surgeons attach themselves to an army and move with it. At the end of each battle the Surgeon rolls a D6:

D6	Result
1–2	No effect
3–4	Casualties reduced by 5%
5–6	Casualties reduced by 10%

When the army retreats the Surgeon must roll a D6. On a 1 the Surgeon fails to withdraw and is killed.

Move	Requires
With army	Medical College

Saboteur — 50 Resources

Saboteurs hinder construction and slow the movement of enemy units.

Hindering Construction: Roll a D6. On a 4+ the construction is halted that turn; on a 6 it regresses by one turn.

Slowing Units: On a 6, the enemy unit's movement is reduced by 1 region. When slowing an enemy army, the Saboteur is killed on a natural 1.

Move	Requires
2 regions	Demolition Guild

Supply Wagon — 25 Resources

A Supply Wagon can hold up to 400 Resources at a time, and may freely withdraw or deposit Resources from armies or territories.

A Supply Wagon that interacts with an enemy army loses all of its supplies, and half of them are gained by the enemy player.

A Supply Wagon spends **2 movement** whenever it enters or leaves a **Neutral** territory, so it cannot rush through unclaimed land into enemy territory.

A Supply Wagon is **never captured while one of its own side's armies is with it** in the same territory.

Move	Capacity
3 regions	400 RP

Resources

Resources are collected in each territory at the start of every turn. Every territory a faction controls has a base generation of **25 Resources per turn**. Neutral territories generate nothing. These may be picked up and carried by armies or Supply Wagons.

Local Supply

Resources must be used locally – they cannot be spent in another territory without first being transported there. An army can carry Resources equal to its points value.

Army Upkeep

An army outside its own territory eats from the Resources it carries at the start of every turn: **25 per turn** for a 400 or 600 point army, **50 per turn** for an 800 or 1000 point army. Inside friendly territory it lives off the land and pays nothing.

Out of Supplies

An army outside friendly territory carrying no Resources is out of supplies. It cannot move (it may still retreat), and in battle all its models suffer **+2 Courage**. It recovers as soon as a Supply Wagon or a neighbouring army brings it Resources.

Spoils of War

When an army is defeated in battle, the Resources it carries are lost and plundered as follows:

Result	Resources Lost	Enemy Gains
Broken	50%	Half of lost
Quartered	75%	Half of lost
Destroyed	All	Half of total

An army beaten while conquering the winner's territory drops twice as many Resources (see Pressing the Advantage).

When an enemy conquers a territory, they gain all of the Resources left within it.

BUILDINGS

Fortify your lands, train your agents and pave the roads to war. A territory can hold at most 4 buildings, counting any still being built.

Building	Cost	Turns	Effect
Hospital	150	3	Replenishing here costs 25/50/75/100 fewer Resources for 400/600/800/1,000 point armies.
Mustering Grounds	100	2	Building an army here takes 1 fewer turn.
Tavern	75	2	Allows recruitment of Scouts. You may have as many Scouts as you have Taverns.
Medical College	100	3	Allows recruitment of Surgeons. You may have as many Surgeons as you have Medical Colleges.
Slums	100	3	Allows recruitment of Assassins. You may have as many Assassins as you have Slums.
Demolition Guild	75	2	Allows recruitment of Saboteurs. You may have as many Saboteurs as you have Demolition Guilds.
Roads	150	4	Leaving this region costs no movement. An army can benefit from Roads once per turn; Agents and Supply Wagons up to 3 times per turn. Further road crossings that turn cost the usual move.
Fortifications	150	3	Any battle in this territory becomes a Siege battle. The defender gains a 400 point garrison army in addition to any army already stationed there. While it holds, the owner's adjacent territories cannot be conquered, and adjacent Neutral territories take the enemy one extra turn to conquer.
Fortress Upgrade	150	2	Only in a territory with finished Fortifications. Raises its garrison to **600**, then **800**, then **1,000 points**: up to three upgrades, built **one at a time**. An upgrade does not count towards the 4 buildings.
City	200	4	The territory generates +25 Resources per turn, and takes an additional turn to fully conquer. Each City also raises your Point Cap by 600 points. You may have only **1 City for every 4 territories** you own, counting Cities still being built.
Scout Tower	100	2	Reveals the details of enemy armies in adjacent territories. The owner gains +1 to all Priority rolls in battles fought here. In battles here or in any adjacent territory, the owner's army chooses who deploys first, regardless of scenario rules or warband totals.
Ballista Tower	50	2	In battles fought here, the owner places a Ballista Tower in their deployment zone. It has a Shoot Value of 4+, a Strength of 8 and a range of 48", and follows the normal MESBG Ballista scatter rules. It can be fired up to three times a game, and is destroyed if an enemy model is in base contact with it and unengaged during a Fight phase.
Land Mapping	50	2	In this territory and every territory adjacent to it, nothing can hinder the owner's movement: Road Blockages, snowed-in events and the extra cost of Neutral territory for Supply Wagons have no effect on their pieces.

Conquest & Heroes

Conquering Territories

An army conquers a territory by holding it, with no enemy army present, through the End stage of enough turns (winning a battle there can speed this up; see Battles): **2 turns** for a Neutral territory and **3 turns** for a territory controlled by the enemy. It then takes control of any buildings inside.

Fortress Lines

A territory adjacent to a friendly territory with Fortifications cannot be conquered until the fortified territory itself has been captured. A Neutral territory adjacent to Fortifications takes one further turn to conquer for any army not belonging to the fortress's owner.

Territory Actions

During the Logistics stage an army may take one action in the territory it occupies. Doing so ends its movement for the turn. Actions complete at the end of the turn; if the army is caught in a battle first, the action is cancelled. Actions marked **(secret)** are hidden from the enemy until an enemy army enters the territory, an enemy Scout is there, or an enemy Scout Tower stands in or next to it. Public actions are marked on the map.

Pillage

Take half of the Resources stored in an enemy territory. It produces no Resources for 1 turn.

Sabotage

Destroy a building that is being constructed in an enemy territory.

Scorched Earth

Destroy every building in one of your own territories. It produces no Resources for 4 turns.

Road Blockage (secret)

An army or Supply Wagon that travels into the territory has its movement ended there, and leaving it takes its entire next move; the blockage is then cleared. It affects friendly units too, except that the army that built it leaves normally the first time.

Dig In (secret)

Until the army leaves the territory, any battle fought there must use the Dig-In Defense scenario (page 28).

Sow Discontent (secret)

A Neutral territory takes one additional turn to conquer, for anyone. It passes after the first conquest.

Heroic Duels

When two armies engage in battle, a Leader with the **Heroic Challenge** Heroic Action may challenge the enemy Leader to single combat.

Heroic Duel

If the challenge is accepted, the two Leaders fight a duel. The loser is forced to retreat from the field, and that Leader is missing from their army until the end of the next turn.

Heroic Marches

A Leader with **Heroic March** as a Heroic Action may declare it to move their army an extra region.

Exhaustion

A Heroic March leaves the army exhausted. The entire army loses 1″ of movement for the next 2 turns.

Special Rules

War in Eriador

Each campaign gives Good and Evil three special rules of their own, drawn from the history of that land. A rule marked declared must be announced by its player at the moment given; the others are always in force.

Forces of Good

Hobbit Laborers

The Hobbits have pledged themselves to the cause and help build the roads: Roads take Good 1 less turn to build.

Dúnedain Scouts

Good Scouts learn what an enemy army contains on a 2+ instead of a 3+. In a battle where a Good Scout is in the territory, Good's army gains a free Ranger of the North model for that battle.

Círdan's Palantír *declared*

In the Priority stage, before any dice are rolled, Good may use the Palantír to win priority automatically. 5 turn cooldown.

Forces of Evil

Rhudaur Raiders

An army of 400 points or less that pillages a territory gains an extra 50 RP. The territory only loses what was taken from it.

Goblin Cunning

Moria armies can move through territories with enemy armies without stopping. If one ends the Logistics stage in the same territory as an enemy army, it is engaged as normal.

Iron Fist of Angmar *declared*

At the start of the Logistics stage, before either player has done anything, Evil may declare it: every Evil army moves 1 extra region this turn, and an army led by the Witch-king of Angmar moves first regardless of priority. 5 turn cooldown.

Special Rules

War in Rohan

Forces of Good

Swiftness of the Riddermark

A Heroic March gives +2 regions instead of +1.

The Hornburg

Good starts with Fortifications in the Hornburg (Helm's Deep); its garrison is 600 points instead of 400 (Fortress Upgrades take it to 800, then 1,000).

Forth Eorlingas! *declared*

Once per campaign, after a friendly territory is lost, Good may raise a free 600 point Kingdom of Rohan army in an adjacent friendly territory, ready at once. It can take no Heroes other than a Captain of Rohan.

Forces of Evil

An Army Worthy of Mordor

Evil starts the campaign with a free 400 point Army of the White Hand in its capital.

Tear Them All Down

Evil's capital builds everything 1 turn quicker.

Tongue of a Worm *declared*

In the Logistics stage, Evil may target a Good army led by a Hero of Legend: on a 3+ it cannot move this turn unless forced to retreat. Usable every turn.

The Rohan Theatre

Setting Out in Rohan

Four Territories Each

In the Rohan campaign each side starts with only four territories instead of eight. Good holds Edoras (its capital), Helm's Deep, Dunharrow and Entwade. Evil holds Isengard (its capital), the Fords of Isen, the Isen Downs and the Dunland Fells.

Theatre Rules

These rules belong to the Rohan theatre as a whole rather than to either side.

Wrath of the Ents

If Evil holds two or more of Wellinghall, Treegarth, Limsworth and Entmoot, a 600 point Fangorn army awakens in Entmoot under Good's command. It may only move into those four territories and must be used to retake them. Once none of them is left in Evil hands, the territories it retook return to Neutral and the Ents go home. If the Fangorn army is destroyed, the Ents never march again.

Powers of Industry

Wellinghall, Treegarth, Limsworth and Entmoot each produce 25 extra RP a turn while Evil holds them. This stacks with any City built there.

Special Rules

War in Gondor

Forces of Good

Splendor of the White City

Good's capital starts with Fortifications and a City, and its City gives +50 RP instead of +25. The capital's Fortifications don't protect West Osgiliath, but while West Osgiliath stands no enemy army or model can pass through the capital, whatever their special rules.

Stubbornness of Stewards

declared

Denethor and Aragorn can't both lead armies unless Boromir also leads one. Aragorn leading without Denethor: -1 Courage for his army. Denethor leading without Aragorn: once per Logistics stage he may look into his Palantír at any Evil army, revealing it on a 2+. All three leading: Good's capital produces +25 RP a turn.

The Beacons Are Lit *declared*

Once per campaign, at the start of any stage while Denethor leads an army, Good may light the beacons: Denethor is replaced as leader for good, and at the start of the 3rd turn after, a 1000 point Kingdom of Rohan army appears next to Good's capital. Not allowed while the capital is in enemy hands or while Good holds East or West Osgiliath.

Forces of Evil

The Hordes of Mordor

Evil starts the campaign with a free 600 point Legion of Mordor army, with no named Heroes and no Monsters, in its capital. It doesn't count against Evil's Point Cap.

The Corsairs of Umbar

When an Umbar army (one raised from the Umbar or Corsair lists) finishes raising, Evil may move it at once to a territory next to the sea or the Anduin; this doesn't use its movement. Umbar armies treat territories next to the sea or the Anduin as if they had Roads.

The Eye of Sauron *declared*

At the start of the Logistics stage Evil may pick a territory: armies that start in it, pass through it or stop in it are revealed. In a battle there, the Good army has +1 Courage and the Evil army -1 Courage.

The Gondor Theatre

Setting Out in Gondor

Established Power

Both sides start with 12 territories. Good holds Minas Tirith (its capital), West Osgiliath, Cair Andros, the Crossings of Erui, Lossarnach, Pelargir, Lebennin, Tarnost, Linhir, the Ringló Vale, Lamedon and Edhellond. Evil holds Barad-dûr (its capital), East Osgiliath, Orodruin, Gorgoroth, Thaurand, Nurn, Ered Glamoth, Lithlad, Beregost, Udûn, Cirith Ungol and Minas Morgul.

The Dead City

Evil starts the campaign with **Fortifications** and a **City** in Minas Morgul.

The Anduin

No territory borders another across the Anduin except East and West Osgiliath: the river can otherwise only be crossed by water (below).

Theatre Rules

These rules belong to the Gondor theatre as a whole rather than to either side.

The River Anduin

An army in a territory on the Anduin or the sea may pay 25 RP for each territory it passes, from the RP it carries, to sail up to 4 territories along the shore at once. This uses only 1 point of its movement. It may instead cross the Anduin to a territory on the far bank for a flat 75 RP, which ends its movement.
Example: pay 100 RP to sail from Belfalas to the Crossings of Erui, or 75 RP to cross the Anduin from Emyn Arnen to the Crossings of Erui.

Osgiliath Fatigue

An army that stays in East or West Osgiliath for more than 1 turn slowly loses heart: its Courage is worsened by 2, then by 1 more for each further turn, to a worst of 4. It recovers after a turn in a friendly territory.

Special Rules

War in the North

Forces of Good

The Riches of Erebor

Erebor's City is unique: Good can upgrade it up to three times, one upgrade at a time, for 150 RP each (2 turns). Each upgrade adds +50 RP to what Erebor makes, and counts as one more City, both for Good's Point Cap and for the limit on Cities.

Alliances Renewed

Once Good has captured both Thranduil's Halls and the Iron Hills, it at once gains a free 600 point Battle of the Five Armies army in Erebor.

I'm a Burglar

An army led by Bilbo Baggins is never forced to fight a battle. But if an enemy army is in Bilbo's territory, he must use the next Logistics stage to move out of it.

Forces of Evil

The Finest Mercenaries *declared*

In the Logistics stage, before it moves, an Easterling army may be sent off the map to fight as mercenaries. It is gone until the end of the next Logistics stage, then returns where it left, bringing 100 RP. Each Easterling army can do this once every 4 turns.

Protected Lands

Evil's lands are split between Dol Guldur, Gundabad and Mistrand, and it needs its fortresses: all three start the campaign with Fortifications.

Azog the Head-taker

If Azog takes part in a battle and personally slays the leader of an enemy army, that army counts as Quartered whoever won and whatever its real losses, unless it was destroyed. An army that loses to an army led by Azog has +1 Courage whenever it faces Azog's force from then on; this happens only once to each army.

The Northern Theatre

Setting Out in the North

The North Divided

Good starts with only two territories, Erebor (its capital) and Esgaroth; both begin the campaign with a **City**. Evil starts with six, in three holds far apart: Dol Guldur (its capital) and Southern Mirkwood, Gundabad and the Sources of the Anduin, and Mistrand and Rhûn.

The Anduin

No territory borders another across the Anduin except at its crossings: the Sources of the Anduin with Gundabad and the Eagles' Eyrie, Beorn's Hall with the Carrock, and the Old Ford with the Carrock and Goblin-town. Elsewhere the river can only be crossed by water (below).

Theatre Rules

These rules belong to the Northern theatre as a whole rather than to either side.

Shattered Alliances

Good can't raise Woodland Realm armies until it has taken Thranduil's Halls, or Iron Hills armies until it has taken the Iron Hills.

Dangers of Mirkwood

Entering a Mirkwood territory costs 1 extra point of movement, except for Woodland Realm and Shadows of Mirkwood armies.

Glittering Gold

Once Erebor's City has all three upgrades, Evil rolls a D6 at the start of every Logistics stage: on a 3+ the **Desolators of the North**, a unique 700 point army, appear in Erebor. They follow every rule for an 800 point army, but always move 3, gain nothing from Roads and can never have their movement hindered. They don't count against Evil's Point Cap.

The River Anduin

An army in a territory on the Anduin, or on the Long Lake, the River Running or the Sea of Rhûn, may pay 25 RP for each territory it passes, from the RP it carries, to sail up to 4 territories along the shore at once. This uses only 1 point of its movement. It may instead cross the Anduin to a territory on the far bank for a flat 75 RP, which ends its movement.

Random Events

The wider world does not wait on the war. At the start of each turn, once priority has been decided, the player who won priority rolls a D6. On a 4+ nothing happens. On a 3 or lower, both players roll a D10 on their own Random Event table and resolve the result straight away.

War in Eriador

Good Random Events

D10	Event
1	**Hobbit Holiday.** The Hobbits are celebrating! Joyous news spreads through Eriador, but the feasting empties the coffers: four random Good territories lose 25 RP, and any construction under way in them moves 1 turn closer to completion.
2	**Passing of the Elves.** A fresh Crossing sets sail into the West, a day of celebration and mourning for every Elf. Armies led by Elves cannot move this turn, but if they fight a battle this turn they start it with 4 victory points already achieved.
3	**Dúnedain Resurgence.** More of the Dúnedain have come of age: Good gains 1 free Scout at its capital.
4	**Great Drought.** A drought has ruined the farms and the territories cling to their stores: this turn no wagon or army may pick up RP from a Good territory.
5	**Snowed In.** A snowstorm buries one Good army's camp: it cannot move this turn, and nobody can enter or pass through its territory until the end of the turn.
6	**Passing Mercenaries.** A mercenary company seeks an employer. This turn, a Good territory with enough RP may hire a 400 point Mercenary army for the price of a normal 400 point army (150 RP). It is ready at once.
7	**Bandit Raid.** Bandits raid a random Good territory: it is pillaged, losing half its stockpile and its next turn of supplies. The plunder simply vanishes.
8	**Dwarven Gifts.** The Dwarves of Ered Luin send a gift of gems: a random Good territory gains 100 RP.
9	**Sweeping Illness.** A swift plague strikes one Good army: it suffers 25% casualties.
10	**Tomb of Kings.** A Good army stumbles on a tomb of the old kings and is inspired: its Courage is improved by 2 until the end of its next battle.

Evil Random Events

D10	Event
1	**Missive from Mordor.** Mordor names a Good territory that must be seized: if Evil conquers it within the next 8 turns, Evil gains 300 RP at its capital. Happens once per campaign; no penalty for failing.
2	**Troll Hoard Discovered.** A random Evil army finds an old Troll hoard. If it raids it, roll a D6: on a 4+ it gains 200 RP; otherwise it suffers 25% casualties and must retreat in the Retreat stage, even if it fights and wins this turn.
3	**Rhudaur Discontent.** The Men of Rhudaur chafe under the Dark Lord's cruelty: the Courage of Rhudaur units is worsened by 2 until the end of the turn.
4	**Craving Man-flesh.** The Orcs and Goblins hunger for man-flesh: any Evil army with Orcs or Goblins that does not fight a battle this turn refuses to move next turn; any that does fight may declare a free army-wide Heroic March on the first turn of the battle.
5	**Eclipse.** An eclipse darkens the hated Sun: the first army Evil moves this turn gets +1 movement.
6	**Sweeping Illness.** A swift plague strikes one Evil army: it suffers 25% casualties.
7	**Bandit Raid.** Bandits raid a random Evil territory: it is pillaged, losing half its stockpile and its next turn of supplies. The plunder simply vanishes.
8	**Great Drought.** A drought has ruined the farms and the territories cling to their stores: this turn no wagon or army may pick up RP from an Evil territory.
9	**Snowed In.** A snowstorm buries one Evil army's camp: it cannot move this turn, and nobody can enter or pass through its territory until the end of the turn.
10	**Passing Mercenaries.** A mercenary company seeks an employer. This turn, an Evil territory with enough RP may hire a 400 point Mercenary army for the price of a normal 400 point army (150 RP). It is ready at once.

War in Rohan

Good Random Events

D10	Event
1	**Peasants' Pride.** The peasants of Rohan are a proud people who will not be subjugated by evil easily: no Good territory can be conquered this turn, and any conquest of a Good territory already under way is paused.
2	**Gondor's Relief.** Gondor has sent supplies in our dire need: Good gains 100 RP at its capital.
3	**Sickness of Théoden.** Théoden King has briefly fallen under the evil spell of Saruman: the Courage of every Good army is worsened by 1 in battles this turn.
4	**Sick Horses.** The horse plague has returned: cavalry-only Good armies cannot move this turn.
5	**Eorl's Birthday.** The birthday of our honoured ancestor has arrived, a joyous occasion. Good may spend 100 RP from any of its territories to improve the Courage of every Good army by 2 in battles this turn.
6	**Great Drought.** A drought has ruined the farms and the territories cling to their stores: this turn no wagon or army may pick up RP from a Good territory.
7	**Snowed In.** A snowstorm buries one Good army's camp: it cannot move this turn, and nobody can enter or pass through its territory until the end of the turn.
8	**Passing Mercenaries.** A mercenary company seeks an employer. This turn, a Good territory with enough RP may hire a 400 point Mercenary army for the price of a normal 400 point army (150 RP). It is ready at once.
9	**Bandit Raid.** Bandits raid a random Good territory: it is pillaged, losing half its stockpile and its next turn of supplies. The plunder simply vanishes.
10	**Sweeping Illness.** A swift plague strikes one Good army: it suffers 25% casualties.

Evil Random Events

D10	Event
1	**Maggoty Bread.** The Orcs don't like the maggoty bread they are served and have become enraged: one random Evil army refuses to move this turn, and if it fights a battle this turn its Courage is worsened by 2.
2	**Mordor Ilk.** The proud Uruk-hai do not like working with the Mordor rabble and a brawl has broken out: one random Evil army rolls a D6. On a 3+ nothing happens; otherwise it suffers 25% casualties.
3	**Dunland's Rage.** The Men of Dunland are eager to slaughter the people of Rohan: this turn Evil armies gain an extra 50 RP from pillaging, and the Courage of an Evil army that pillages this turn is improved by 1 in battles this turn.
4	**Fell Speech of Saruman.** Saruman has harnessed the power of his voice: Evil chooses one Good army, and it cannot move this turn.
5	**Goblins Come.** Goblins have come down from the Misty Mountains to deal with the White Wizard. Evil may pay them 100 RP from any of its territories; they then run amok in Rohan, and one Good army that Evil chooses, standing in a Good territory, suffers 25% casualties.
6	**Great Drought.** A drought has ruined the farms and the territories cling to their stores: this turn no wagon or army may pick up RP from an Evil territory.
7	**Snowed In.** A snowstorm buries one Evil army's camp: it cannot move this turn, and nobody can enter or pass through its territory until the end of the turn.
8	**Passing Mercenaries.** A mercenary company seeks an employer. This turn, an Evil territory with enough RP may hire a 400 point Mercenary army for the price of a normal 400 point army (150 RP). It is ready at once.
9	**Bandit Raid.** Bandits raid a random Evil territory: it is pillaged, losing half its stockpile and its next turn of supplies. The plunder simply vanishes.
10	**Sweeping Illness.** A swift plague strikes one Evil army: it suffers 25% casualties.

War in Gondor

Good Random Events

D10	Event
1	**Boromir's Courage.** The Hero of Gondor's courage spreads through the forces of Good: the Courage of every Good army is improved by 2 in battles this turn, and by 3 for an army led by Boromir.
2	**Denethor's Insight.** Denethor has long probed the enemy's defences: one random enemy territory bordering Good land takes 1 turn less to conquer, provided a Good army starts conquering it this turn.
3	**Denethor's Madness.** Seeing the Legions of Evil, Denethor's failing will gives way to madness and he refuses to strike at Mordor: this turn no Good army may enter enemy territory or a territory holding an Evil army, except an army led by Aragorn.
4	**War Fatigue.** The war has gone on too long and the people of Gondor are weary: roll a D6 for each Good army. On a 2+ nothing happens; otherwise it suffers 25% casualties as its men give up the fight.
5	**Return of the King.** If Aragorn is not yet leading an army, Good may at once raise a 400 point Men of the West army led by him at its capital. If it does, no army may contain Denethor from then on. Optional; happens once per campaign.
6	**Great Drought.** A drought has ruined the farms and the territories cling to their stores: this turn no wagon or army may pick up RP from a Good territory.
7	**Snowed In.** A snowstorm buries one Good army's camp: it cannot move this turn, and nobody can enter or pass through its territory until the end of the turn.
8	**Passing Mercenaries.** A mercenary company seeks an employer. This turn, a Good territory with enough RP may hire a 400 point Mercenary army for the price of a normal 400 point army (150 RP). It is ready at once.
9	**Bandit Raid.** Bandits raid a random Good territory: it is pillaged, losing half its stockpile and its next turn of supplies. The plunder simply vanishes.
10	**Sweeping Illness.** A swift plague strikes one Good army: it suffers 25% casualties.

Evil Random Events

D10	Event
1	**Sauron's Will.** Sauron bends his worshippers to his mighty will: Evil chooses one Evil army, which gets +1 movement this turn. If it fights a battle this turn, it may declare a free army-wide Heroic March on the first turn of that battle.
2	**Tribute to the Dark Lord.** Rhûn has sent a tribute of gold to show its loyalty: Evil gains 100 RP at its capital.
3	**Slave Rebellion.** The slaves are revolting: every Evil territory loses 25 RP, and construction in Evil territories is paused this turn.
4	**Sauron's Paranoia.** Sauron grows paranoid at rumours of the return of Isildur's line and wants the war over: one random Evil army must move as close as it can to the nearest Good army this turn, and if it can reach that army it must. It need not use a Heroic March.
5	**Dark Rituals.** Fell things stir in the darkest pits of Mordor. Evil may attempt a Dark Ritual: roll a D6. On a 3+ the Courage of every Evil army is improved by 3 in battles this turn; otherwise no Evil army can move this turn. Optional.
6	**Great Drought.** A drought has ruined the farms and the territories cling to their stores: this turn no wagon or army may pick up RP from an Evil territory.
7	**Snowed In.** A snowstorm buries one Evil army's camp: it cannot move this turn, and nobody can enter or pass through its territory until the end of the turn.
8	**Passing Mercenaries.** A mercenary company seeks an employer. This turn, an Evil territory with enough RP may hire a 400 point Mercenary army for the price of a normal 400 point army (150 RP). It is ready at once.
9	**Bandit Raid.** Bandits raid a random Evil territory: it is pillaged, losing half its stockpile and its next turn of supplies. The plunder simply vanishes.
10	**Sweeping Illness.** A swift plague strikes one Evil army: it suffers 25% casualties.

War in the North

Good Random Events

D10	Event
1	**Dragon Sickness.** The glitter of gold pierces even the sharpest of minds in time: one random Good army cannot move this turn, and at once pillages the territory it stands in. That RP is lost, even from a Good territory.
2	**Bad Blood.** Old grudges stir: every army with both Elves and Dwarves rolls a D6, and on a 3+ it has +1 Courage this turn.
3	**Durin's Birthday.** A day of great celebration, the birthday of the great ancestor: every Dwarven army automatically passes any Courage test it makes this turn. Break tests are made as normal.
4	**Gift from Balin.** Balin has sent a mighty gift from Khazad-dûm: Good gains 150 RP at its capital.
5	**The Arkenstone.** The Arkenstone has been found! One random Good army may take it. If it does, any territory it is in makes +25 RP, and replenishing or upgrading it costs 50 RP less; but its Heroes can never use Stand Fast!, and its leader has +2 Courage. This choice can only ever be made once.
6	**Great Drought.** A drought has ruined the farms and the territories cling to their stores: this turn no wagon or army may pick up RP from a Good territory.
7	**Snowed In.** A snowstorm buries one Good army's camp: it cannot move this turn, and nobody can enter or pass through its territory until the end of the turn.
8	**Passing Mercenaries.** A mercenary company seeks an employer. This turn, a Good territory with enough RP may hire a 400 point Mercenary army for the price of a normal 400 point army (150 RP). It is ready at once.
9	**Bandit Raid.** Bandits raid a random Good territory: it is pillaged, losing half its stockpile and its next turn of supplies. The plunder simply vanishes.
10	**Sweeping Illness.** A swift plague strikes one Good army: it suffers 25% casualties.

Evil Random Events

D10	Event
1	**Easterling Greed.** The Easterlings want more gold and have taken to raiding even Neutral lands: this turn no Neutral territory can be conquered, and conquests of Neutral territories already under way are paused.
2	**Dwarven Hatred.** Every army with Azog in it must move as close as it can to an enemy army, to bring it to battle.
3	**Gifts from Goblin-town.** The Goblins have sent a mighty gift: Evil gains 150 RP at its capital.
4	**Mercenary Boom.** Mercenaries are in great demand: Easterling armies returning from mercenary work this turn bring back 50 RP more.
5	**March of Gundabad.** The war horns of Gundabad have sounded: every Evil army may move 1 extra territory this turn. One that does is exhausted, as if it had made a Heroic March; if the extra move took it into battle, the exhaustion waits until next turn.
6	**Great Drought.** A drought has ruined the farms and the territories cling to their stores: this turn no wagon or army may pick up RP from an Evil territory.
7	**Snowed In.** A snowstorm buries one Evil army's camp: it cannot move this turn, and nobody can enter or pass through its territory until the end of the turn.
8	**Passing Mercenaries.** A mercenary company seeks an employer. This turn, an Evil territory with enough RP may hire a 400 point Mercenary army for the price of a normal 400 point army (150 RP). It is ready at once.
9	**Bandit Raid.** Bandits raid a random Evil territory: it is pillaged, losing half its stockpile and its next turn of supplies. The plunder simply vanishes.
10	**Sweeping Illness.** A swift plague strikes one Evil army: it suffers 25% casualties.

Dig-In Defense

The Defenders have dug in, throwing up barricades and raising platforms for their archers. The Attacker must drive them from the territory, or break upon their walls.

Scenario Outline

The Attacker attempts to dislodge the Defenders from the territory.

The Armies

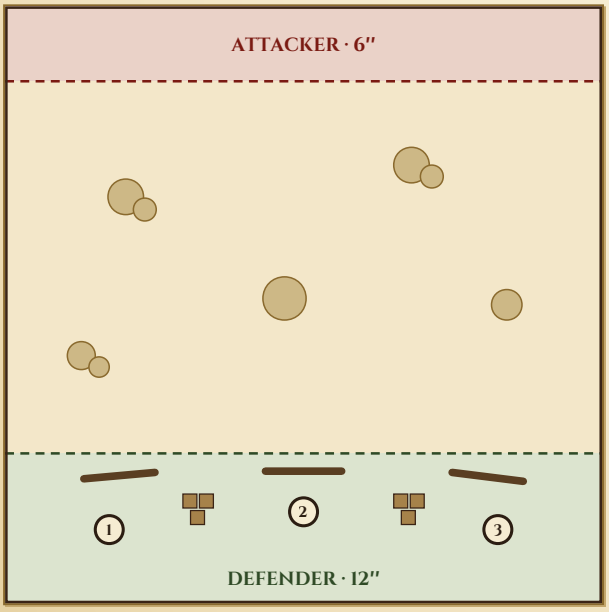
Armies are decided as part of the War in Middle-earth rules.

Layout

The Defending player places three fences, barricades or low walls, each up to 6″ long and 1″ wide, anywhere within their deployment zone. They may also place up to nine crates, or crate-like objects, within their deployment zone, to be used as archer platforms.

The Defender then places three objectives within their deployment zone. Each must be at least 6″ from any board edge and from any other objective.

Players are free to make adjustments to these terrain pieces and to what counts as them.



Example deployment: barricades, crates and the three objectives.

Starting Positions

The Defender's deployment zone is within 12″ of their chosen board edge. The Attacker's deployment zone is within 6″ of the opposite board edge.

The Defender must place all of their Warbands first.

Objectives

The game lasts until the end of a turn in which one Army has been reduced to a quarter (25%) of its starting number of models or below, at which point the player who has scored the most Victory Points wins the game. If both players have the same number of Victory Points, the Defender wins.

Scoring Victory Points

2 Defender
For every objective within their control at the end of the game. If all three are in the Defender's control, they score **4** extra Victory Points.

3 Attacker
For every objective within their control at the end of the game. If all three are in the Attacker's control, they score **4** extra Victory Points.

2 Either player
If the enemy Army is Broken at the end of the game. If the enemy Army is Broken and theirs is not, they instead score **3** Victory Points.

4 Defender
If their Army is not Quartered at the end of the game.